Countless caravans of carts brought food and construction materials to the site. Warehouses were built to store them. Visitors came, too, because they wanted to see the wondrous project being built. Lodging had to be provided for these people.

Most large buildings in Mogul India—like the Red Fort, for instance—were made from red sandstone. However, Mumtaz's final resting place had to be special. The main tomb and the massive platform on which it stood were to be made of marble.

The marble came from far away. There was a quarry at Makrana, more than two hundred miles to the west. Shah Jahan ordered that all the marble from there was to be used for the tomb.

